

Strategic Solution Paths

Defensible recommendations and marking red lines

Client	Generation Bridge Foundation
Document reference	GBF Case Key
Classification	ANSWER KEY - FACILITATOR ONLY
Version	3.1 July-September 2026

There is no single correct strategy. Reward evidence-based reasoning. The paths below are strong; weak teams pick a slogan and ignore contradicting evidence.

Path A - Depth before scale

Thesis: Pause expansion; fix Dong Nai and employer quality; negotiate a smaller quality-focused VPBank grant.

Strengths: Honest about D-02; addresses EP-02, ST-05, BN-02; sustainable operations.

Who is left behind: The ~1,100 on the waitlist (esp. Binh Duong / BN-04, YouthWorks leakage); Long An ambition and the Board growth faction; possibly part of the VPBank envelope if the grant is renegotiated down.

Risks to probe in Q&A: May leave funding on the table; must convince VPBank with a credible theory of change (DN-01).

Path B - Conditional scale (most common strong answer)

Thesis: Accept VPBank but gate expansion behind quality milestones; fix Dong Nai first, then Long An.

Strengths: Balances donor pressure and field reality; stages risk; keeps the grant.

Who is left behind: Whoever sits behind the gates - waitlisted youth until milestones clear; Long An if gates stay closed; young people who need help now while process/M&E work runs. Soft risk: staff burn if 'fix in parallel' becomes two full jobs.

Risks to probe in Q&A: Execution-heavy; requires M&E discipline teams must propose credibly.

Path C - Employer-led pivot

Thesis: Audit and certify employers; place only with vetted partners; make quality the brand.

Strengths: Answers EP-02 and ST-05 directly; differentiates from YouthWorks on outcomes not speed.

Who is left behind: Youth who would have taken weaker/exploitative placements for a short-term job; hubs that depend on volume employers (Dong Nai under pressure); anyone for whom fewer seats means a longer wait. Employers who fail the audit - and the young people those firms would have absorbed.

Risks to probe in Q&A: Slower growth; depends on employer cooperation.

Path D - Digital hybrid

Thesis: Grow Pathway Digital for reach; keep Skills Forward for depth and placement quality.

Strengths: Lower unit cost (D-12); addresses waitlist pressure.

Who is left behind: Youth without devices/connectivity (BN-01); people who need in-person support (disability pathway, weaker digital skills - BN-03 risk); anyone steered into Digital who would have done better on Skills Forward's stronger placement quality. Waitlist may shrink on paper while equity quietly worsens.

Risks to probe in Q&A: Digital placement weaker; equity risk (BN-01); only strong with explicit caveats.

Across all four paths (if teams do not name it): young people with disability, Dong Nai participants stuck in bad internships, and anyone cherry-picked out to protect the 65% remain the red-line 'left behind' groups - not a free pass for any path.

Red lines - mark down if recommended

- Reporting a shorter window than ninety days as the primary placement metric (contradicts D-03 Clauses 3-4 and DN-01; often floated as 'earlier visibility').
- Replacing paid caseworkers with volunteers (contradicts VR-01).
- National or provincial scale with no plan to fix Dong Nai.
- Cherry-picking easier-to-place youth to hit 65% without acknowledging the cost.
- Treating D-08 board emails as verified fact.
- Claiming attendance causes placement without naming confounders.
- Workflow A citing operational numbers without Request / Findings IDs.
- Workflow B sharing the raw workbook with A.